# Ishkhan Khchoian

## Product Manager — discovery, requirements & delivery

Yerevan, Armenia · remote, or on-site / hybrid in Yerevan · open to relocation
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English (C1) · Russian (native) · Armenian (native)

### PROFILE

Product manager with over six years of experience managing projects and client work across different business areas. For the past few years I have worked at the interface between clients and engineering: finding out what users actually need, turning it into requirements and a prioritized backlog, and following delivery through to acceptance. I work with Scrum and Kanban in Jira and Confluence. I completed an IT project management course through a U.S. Embassy program and am taking the PSM I exam in November 2026.

I am currently COO of SayWhen.am, an AI voice-agent startup, where I run development with the CTO and manage the company's corporate clients across the full engagement cycle. Before that I redesigned client-project processes at U.S. companies and delivered construction projects on tight deadlines — results below.

### WHY ME FOR THIS ROLE

- **Discovery.** Hundreds of structured intake interviews with clients who described symptoms rather than problems. Asking past the stated request is the skill a product discovery call needs, and the one I have practiced longest.
- **Requirements engineers can build from.** At SayWhen.am I turn client needs into a specification and a prioritized backlog, then accept each stage with the CTO against those requirements.
- **Process redesign with measurable results.** As a case manager at U.S. legal services companies I rebuilt client-project workflows. At one company the cycle became strictly six months or less, two- and four-month express tracks were introduced, errors decreased, and the share of successful cases rose by 35%.
- **Delivery against fixed deadlines.** In a family construction business I managed an investment project made up of 11 public and private tenders worth RUB 42M; every site was delivered on time and accepted with no defects noted.
- **Technical background.** I understand the software development lifecycle and work with REST APIs, JSON, Postman and Swagger/OpenAPI specs; I completed a C programming intensive at 42 Yerevan and build working prototypes myself with AI tools.

### SKILLS

- **Product:** user interviews and discovery · requirements, user stories and acceptance criteria · backlog refinement · roadmap input · experiment design · metric definition and tracking · competitor and market research
- **Delivery:** Scrum and Kanban · scope and timelines · MoSCoW and RICE prioritization · risk tracking · SOPs and checklists · cross-functional coordination · stakeholder communication
- **Tools:** Jira · Confluence · Miro · Notion · Trello · Monday · Google Analytics · amoCRM · Bitrix24 · Google Workspace · Claude Code

### EXPERIENCE

**COO — SayWhen.am (AI voice-agent startup)** Feb 2026 – present

- Run product development with the CTO in Jira and Confluence: requirements, specification, backlog and priorities, and acceptance of each stage.
- Manage the company's corporate clients across the full engagement cycle: needs discovery, agreement on scope and timelines, and regular progress reporting during implementation.

**Freelance — project and legal work** Feb 2026 – present

- Designed a U.S. client-acquisition pilot for **Karas Systems** (B2B go-to-market consultancy): a three-scenario funnel model, budget, payback and decision gates.
- Business research for a water production line; CPA/affiliate manager (under NDA); legal projects — IP assignment for works by popular musicians, a corporate structure for a crypto trader and advice on opening a crypto-exchange office in Armenia; sale of family real estate.

**Senior Case Manager — M&M Document Preparation (U.S.)** Jun 2025 – Feb 2026

- Owned up to **12 complex client projects at a time**, end to end, against fixed external deadlines.
- Redesigned the delivery process: a cycle of **strictly six months or less**, new **two- and four-month express tracks**, fewer errors through a shared knowledge base, and a **35% higher success rate**.
- Coordinated **8 specialists** and reviewed their work against written acceptance criteria; my templates, checklists and hand-off rules became the team standard.

**Event / Project Manager — Hosq Corp.** Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Delivered live events for **100 to 3,000** people — several in parallel, on dates that could not slip; owned vendors, logistics, scheduling and day-of operations.

**Project Manager — Qanon Construction** Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Client communication, scope agreement, timelines and internal follow-through.

**Legal practice — U.S. law firms, Arbitration Court, Bar Association** Dec 2019 – Aug 2024

- Senior Paralegal at Shamayev Business Law, Paralegal at Bloomrich Law Firm: built the internal training program **Paralegal Academy** (50+ people) and improved the firms' internal processes.
- Judge's Associate: **200+ concurrent cases, 30+ hearings a week**; earlier, contract analysis and claims work at a Bar Association.

**Project Manager — SIS LLC (family business)** Jun 2015 – Sep 2019

- Managed projects including an **investment project made up of 11 public and private tenders worth RUB 42M** — every site delivered **on time and accepted with no defects noted**.
- Teams of up to 20; procurement, logistics between sites and recruiting; built the first schedules and Gantt charts; set up a regional supply network for the retail business.

## EDUCATION & TRAINING

- **Project management** — "Project Management with a U.S. Perspective: Skills for Global Success" — Yerevan American Corner, a joint program of the U.S. Embassy Yerevan and the City Central Isahakyan Library; Jul 21 – Aug 21, 2026, in person, Certificate of Achievement.
- **Professional Scrum Master I (Scrum.org)** — exam scheduled for November 2026.
- **Project Management (PM Club)** — 2023, 52 hours.
- **Piscine intensive (C programming)** — 42 Yerevan, Nov–Dec 2025; passed selection and completed it alongside a full-time job.
- **Bachelor of Law, with honors** — North-Eastern State University, 2021.
- **Civil Law, Faculty of Law** — St. Petersburg State University, 2016.

## ALSO

- **2nd place, HackNation** local pitches, final at TUMO Labs (July 2026); **Startup Seaside Summit** — participant.
- **Highload++** (700 attendees) — organizing team, led a crew of 12; performance bonus.
- **Ethos Foundation** — HQ coordinator, Sep 2023 – Oct 2024; aid to ~100 families a day.